FreshWay — Company dossier

Smart Logistics (EDSLOG.24) · autumn 2026 · available from lesson 1 to every department

Five factsheets describing FreshWay as a whole. This is what everyone in the company knows. Your own department's operational figures are in your **Tier B** sheet; anything not published here or there can be requested from the Executive Board (**Tier C**).

Three conventions — read these before you use any number.

- **VAT.** Revenue marked *incl. VAT* is consumer spending. All margin and cost percentages apply to **net revenue (excl. VAT)** of €2,211 mln. Applying a cost percentage to the VAT-inclusive figure overstates it by about 10%.
- **Shrink is measured twice.** Food loss and food waste are in **kilograms** against purchase volume; shrink at cost is in **euros**. They are not the same number and mixing them puts you out by a factor of two. Every shrink figure below carries its unit.
- **Confidence.** Every figure carries a label: **H** = hard, from a public source · **A** = derived by calculation from H figures · **S** = estimated, no source carries it. If you build a business case on an **S** figure, say so in your report.

A1 · Company profile

Field	Value	Unit	Conf.
Legal form	**FreshWay B.V.** — private limited company, not listed		—
Stores	120	stores	—
Store formats	96 × FreshWay (1,100-1,600 m²) · 18 × FreshWay XL (2,000-2,800 m²) · 6 × FreshWay City (400-600 m²)		S
Region served	Central and Eastern Netherlands · ~2.4 mln inhabitants		S
Average sales floor per store	1,400	m²	—

Field	Value	Unit	Conf.
Sales density	13,000	€ incl. VAT / m² / year	—
Store revenue	2,184	€ mln incl. VAT / year	A
Online revenue	243	€ mln incl. VAT / year	A
Total chain revenue	**2,430**	€ mln incl. VAT / year	A
Net revenue (excl. VAT)	**2,211**	€ mln / year	A
Online share of revenue	10	%	—
Market share, Dutch grocery	4.6	%	A
Gross margin	28.9 · €639 mln	% of net revenue	A
Operating result	4.0 · €88 mln	% of net revenue	A
Net result	~1.8 · €40 mln	% of net revenue	S
Employees	~14,900 / ~7,400	headcount / FTE	A
Growth	+3.5 revenue · +2.0 volume	% / year	S

Positioning. FreshWay is a **full-service supermarket chain**, not a discounter: a broad assortment, a large fresh share, service at the counter, and own brand next to A-brands. Format, assortment breadth, service level, online maturity and investment capacity are those of the market leader — at a chain scale of

120 stores. That means there **is** capital to invest; see A4. It also means you should never reason from a national market leader's absolute chain figures: FreshWay is a strong regional player, not a national group.

A2 · Network and assets

	CDC Apeldoorn	RDC Noord (Zwolle)	RDC Zuid (Nijmegen)	EFC + 5 hubs
Function	ambient · frozen · non-food	fresh, north	fresh, south	online fulfilment
Area (m²)	30,000	9,000	9,000	15,000 + 5 × 1,200
Throughput (cases/day)	171,000	70,000	70,000	~6,990 orders/day
Roll cages out (per day)	3,420	1,400	1,400	7.7 mln crates/year
Pallets in (per day)	~2,140	~875	~875	—
Stores served	120	60	60	national
Temperature zones	ambient 22,000 m² · −25 °C 6,000 m² · +4 °C 2,000 m²	+2/+7 °C 7,000 m² · ambient 2,000 m²	idem	+2/+7 °C 6,000 m² · rest ambient
Automation	mechanised: shuttle store, palletising robots, AGVs	manual picking, voice	manual picking, voice	goods-to-person
Staff	~245 / ~200 FTE	~175 / ~140 FTE	~175 / ~140 FTE	~450 / ~300 FTE
Shifts	3, six days	2, six days	2, six days	2, six days

	CDC Apeldoorn	RDC Noord (Zwolle)	RDC Zuid (Nijmegen)	EFC + 5 hubs
Pick rate	~700 cases/hour	~400 cases/hour	~400 cases/hour	~250 lines/hour

Network totals	Value	Unit	Conf.
Total DC area, excl. EFC	48,000 · 400 per store	m²	A
Outbound flow to stores	311,000 cases · 6,220 roll cages	per day	A
Flow to the EFC	34,600 cases	per day	A
Total outbound from DCs	**346,000 cases**	per day	A
Inbound pallets	~3,890 (~160 trucks)	per day	A
Operating days	6 per week · 312 per year		—
Store deliveries	2 per store per day		—
Store stops	240	per day	A
Routes, store replenishment	**~139** in a normal week, **193** in the peak week · 1.68 stops per route · 45.4 roll cages per route	per day	A
Average route length	70	km	S
Kilometres, store replenishment	10,360 per day · **3.23 mln per year**	km	A
Tractor units / trailers	54 (40 euro-trailer · 10 city-trailer · 4 rigid) / 70 **double-deck**, 66 roll cages each	vehicles	A/S
Electric share of the truck fleet	15 (8 e-tractors)	%	S
Drivers, store replenishment	~59 FTE / ~65 headcount		A

Network totals	Value	Unit	Conf.
Delivery vans	**82**, 100% electric · 2 routes per van per day · **5,928 deliveries per day**	vehicles	A
Delivery drivers	~274 FTE / ~400 headcount		A
Delivery time windows	06:00-11:00 and 14:00-19:00		S
Stores inside a zero-emission zone	**22**	stores	S
Click & collect	18% of online orders, via 30 stores		S
CO_2, store replenishment	2,400	tonnes/year	A

Why the zero-emission zones matter. Twenty-one Dutch zero-emission zones are in force and the exemption regime changed on 1 January 2026 — including a separate category for companies that cannot get a grid connection because of network congestion. Twenty-two FreshWay stores sit inside one. Before you assume you can charge what you plan to buy, ask **Storage** for the Energy & Capacity File: the central DC has about 0.45 MVA of headroom and full electrification of the truck fleet needs 1.2 MW more.

A3 · Assortment and volumes

Field	Value	Unit	Conf.
Total chain range	21,000	SKU	S (anchored on a market leader's published 21,000+)
Range in an average store	16,000 (XL up to 21,000 · City ~7,000)	SKU	S
Range online	18,000	SKU	S
Suppliers, direct	~450	suppliers	S
Private label share	40	% of revenue	S

Field	Value	Unit	Conf.
Promotional share	**22**	% of revenue	S
Product groups used in reporting	20	groups	—
Cases, chain	1.87 mln per week · **311,000 per day**	cases	A
Roll cages, chain	6,220	per day	A
Revenue per case	22.50	€ incl. VAT	—
Cases per roll cage	50		H
Cases per store	15,560 per week · 2,590 per day	cases	A
Roll cages per store	311 per week · 52 per day		A
Transactions	12,960 per store per week · 1,850 per day · **81 mln per year, chain**		A
Average basket, store	27 · 12 items	€ incl. VAT	S
Average basket, online	95 · 42 lines	€ incl. VAT	S
Online orders	2.55 mln per year · 49,100 per week · **~6,990 per day** (seven days; 18% is collected rather than delivered)	orders	A
Crates per online order	3 · 7.7 mln crates per year		S

Range and revenue by category — the split is an assumption, the order of magnitude is not.

Category	SKUs	% of SKUs	% of revenue	Temperature	Conf.
Ambient grocery	8,000	50	44	ambient	S
Chilled fresh (produce, dairy, meat, fish, ready meals, bread)	4,800	30	38	+2/+7 °C	S
Frozen	1,200	7.5	6	−18/−25 °C	S
Non-food	2,000	12.5	12	ambient	S
Total	**16,000**	**100**	**100**		

> **Read this before you build on the table above.** The total range is anchored on a published figure from a comparable full-service chain. **The split across categories is not** — no Dutch source publishes it. It is plausible and internally consistent, and it is an assumption. Use it, and say in your report that you did.

Seasonality (index, an average FreshWay week = 100; **A**). The dataset you receive in lesson 3 covers **ISO week 42 of 2024 through week 2 of 2025**, and the profile over those thirteen weeks is this:

Week	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	01	02
Index	97	99	98	98	99	100	104	106	104	**128**	**111**	96	**89**

Three things about this profile go against intuition. Read them before you draw a conclusion from a weekly average.

1. **The peak is week 51, not week 52.** Christmas Day 2024 falls on a Wednesday, which puts the biggest Saturday of the year — 21 December — inside week 51, while week 52 loses two full trading days to the Christmas holidays.
2. **Week 52 is a week of extremes, not a high week.** Monday 23 and Tuesday 24 December carry more than half of it; Wednesday and Thursday are almost nothing. At week level that averages away. **Read week 52 by the day, or you will draw the wrong conclusion from a mean.** The same applies to week 1: New Year's Eve is a top day and New Year's Day is closed.
3. **Week 1 is not the dip — week 2 is.** W01 lands at 96 because New Year's Eve pulls it up. The real low point of the period is **W02 at 89**.

Two things move on top of the index. Online reacts about 1.35 times as hard as the stores, because delivery slots around the holidays are scarce and customers book earlier. And the **mix** shifts: in week 51 chilled fresh runs at about ×1.35 and frozen at ×1.20 of their normal share, while ambient grocery drops to ×0.95 — so the volume rises *and* moves into the temperature-controlled part of the chain. That mix shift is an assumption (**S**); the week index is derived from public figures (**A**).

A4 · Cost structure and investment room

All percentages apply to **net revenue (excl. VAT) of €2,211 mln**. The structure closes exactly: `100 − 71.1 − 13.0 − 2.0 − 7.5 − 3.7 + 1.3 = 4.0`.

Line	% of net revenue	€ mln	Conf.
Net revenue	100.0	2,211	A
Purchase value of goods, delivered to DC	67.1	1,484	A
Supply chain, store channel	4.0	88	A
Cost of sales	*71.1*	*1,572*	A
Gross margin	**28.9**	**639**	A
Store personnel	13.0	287	A
E-fulfilment and last mile	2.0	44	A
Other operating costs	7.5	166	A
— of which occupancy	3.4	75	H-ratio
— of which energy	0.74	16.3	A on H
— of which other (selling, IT, head office)	3.36	75	A
Depreciation	3.7	82	H-ratio
Other operating income	+1.3	+29	H-ratio
Operating result	**4.0**	**88**	—

Logistics cost in full

Layer	% of net revenue	€ mln	Per unit	Conf.
Inbound to DC	0.3	6	~€4.94 per pallet received	S
Warehousing, 3 DCs	2.2	49	€0.50 per case	S
Outbound, DC → store	0.7	15	€100 per driving hour · €0.15 per case · ~€7.73 per roll cage	S
Supply chain overhead, planning, IT	0.8	18		S
Subtotal, store channel	*4.0*	*88*		
Last mile, home delivery	1.4	31	**€12 per order**	S
E-fulfilment, picking in the EFC	0.6	13	**€5 per order**	S
Total logistics chain	**6.0**	**132**		

Inventory and working capital

Field	Value	Conf.
Inventory value	€57 mln · 14.2 days · 25.8 turns per year	A/H
— in stores	€32 mln · fresh 3 days, shelf-stable 7 days	A
— in the DCs	€25 mln · fresh 1-2 days, ambient 10-14 days, frozen 21 days	S
Days payable	93 days · €378 mln	A
Working capital	**negative, ~ –€290 mln**	A

Shrink — mind the unit

Field	Value	Unit	Conf.
Food loss	1.21	% of purchase volume, **kg**	H
Food waste	0.92	% of purchase volume, **kg**	H
Shrink at cost	2.0 · €30 mln	% · €	S
— fresh categories	~2.5	% of own purchase value	S
— shelf-stable	~0.3	% of own purchase value	S
Online food waste	0.35	% of purchase volume, kg	H
Theft, separate	0.4 · €9 mln	% of store revenue	S
DC shrink	0.15	% of throughput	S

Investment room

Field	Value	Conf.
Annual capital expenditure	**€77 mln = 3.5% of net revenue**	A
— stores, new build and refurbishment	€35 mln (45%)	S
— **supply chain: DCs, mechanisation, equipment**	**€17 mln (22%)**	S
— IT and digital	€15 mln (20%)	S
— sustainability and fleet	€10 mln (13%)	S
Free cash flow	~€60 mln	H-ratio
Net debt	~€450 mln = 2.0 × EBITDA; room to ~2.5 ×	S
Payback required — IT and software	3-5 years	S
Payback required — electric trucks and charging	5-7 years	S

Field	Value	Conf.
Payback required — store refurbishment	6-8 years	S
Payback required — DC mechanisation	6-9 years	S
Hurdle rate	IRR > 12% · WACC ~7.5%	S

> **There is money, and it is not enough for everything.** The **Investment Council** produces one prioritised company investment plan in which the seven departments' proposals together fit inside **€17 mln of supply chain capex per year**, and every proposal meets its payback requirement. To give you the scale: a fully mechanised distribution centre costs €80-150 mln — four to nine years of the entire supply chain budget. Seven departments each submitting a proposal will together ask for more than there is. **That is not a flaw in the case; that is the case.** Say what you would drop.

A5 · IT landscape, as-is

System	Size	Integration	Owner	Known pain
ERP — finance, purchasing, master data	1, company-wide	—	Finance	master data spread across three systems
WMS	1 platform, 4 instances (3 DCs + EFC)	nightly batch to ERP	Supply Chain	no real-time stock view between DCs
WCS/WES — mechanisation	CDC only	real-time to WMS	Supply Chain	vendor-proprietary, closed interface
TMS	1, board computers in 54 tractors	API to WMS, batch to ERP	Transport	route plan and pick sequence not linked
POS	120 stores, ~1,000 tills and self-scans	batch, 4× per day	Retail Operations	sales data only available the next morning

System	Size	Integration	Owner	Known pain
E-commerce platform + OMS	1	API	E-commerce	stock view to the webshop lags 30 minutes
Forecasting and replenishment	**2.52 mln SKU-location combinations**	nightly batch	Inventory & SCM	promotions sit outside the model
EDI	~450 suppliers · ORDERS, DESADV, INVOIC	AS2/EDIFACT	Purchasing	**30% of suppliers send no DESADV**
BI / data warehouse	1	nightly load	Data & Analytics	no source is real-time
Sensors / IoT	3 DCs · 54 trucks · 82 vans · chilled cabinets in 120 stores	MQTT to a platform	Facility	data is stored, not used

Data volumes per year — the BI lesson can calculate with these.

Flow	Volume
Till receipts	**81 mln**
POS lines	~970 mln
Case picks in the DCs	**97 mln**
E-commerce pick lines	**107 mln**
Store deliveries	75,000
Routes	46,000
Home deliveries	2.55 mln
Temperature readings (chilled cabinets, every 15 min)	~420 mln

Regulation pressing on this landscape: EU Data Act (access to data from connected products — telematics, temperature loggers), eFTI (electronic freight information), NIS2, GDPR, and the AI Act for the customer-data and personalisation side. Dates and obligations are in the Compliance File held by **Incoming transport**.

How to read this. This is the **as-is** landscape, not an architecture. It is the spaghetti that lesson 3 is about. Two things are deliberately visible: the same data lives in more than one system, and the connections are a mix of API, batch and file exchange. Your data model in SA2 describes what *should* flow between departments; this table describes what actually does.

Where the rest is

- **Your own department's figures** — your **department file**, released to your department in lesson 1. You have only your own; the other six exist and you do not see them.
- **The data** — see the **Dataset guide**, released in lesson 3. Each department owns one or two datasets; several questions can only be answered by combining sets that sit with two departments.
- **Everything else** — the Board archive. The *Board archive index* lists what exists; request an item with an **Information Request**. Read the rules there first: two requests per department per lesson, and the answer takes two working days.

*All figures come from the FreshWay figure sheet, which is derived from public benchmark data on Dutch grocery retail. Where a figure carries **S**, it is an estimate — treat it as an assumption in your business case, not as a fact.*

> **GenAI transparency.** This factsheet was written with Claude (Anthropic) by the course team, based on the FreshWay case design and on verified benchmark research into Dutch grocery retail. All figures come from a separate, source-checked figure sheet; none were generated by the model. Human-AI Agency Label: **Co-Creator**. Label source: Boetje, J., & Baake, G. (2026). *Nine prototypical human-AI agency patterns* [Figure]. figshare. https://doi.org/10.6084/m9.figshare.31706884 (CC BY 4.0).
